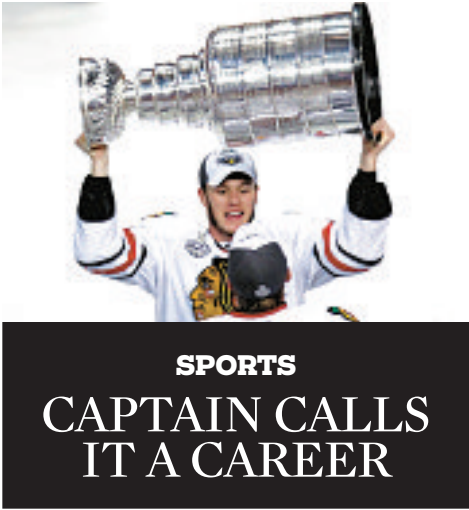


TAKE THAT, OUTBACK

Aided by Alex Freeman's header in the 43rd minute, the U.S. rolls to 2-0 win over Australia in the World Cup, securing spot in knockout round. Coverage in Sports



SPORTS
CAPTAIN CALLS
IT A CAREER

CHICAGOLAND

Boutros' office
drops charges
in ATF case

NATION & WORLD

Contract for
reflecting pool
faces scrutiny

WINNER OF 29 PULITZER PRIZES FOR EXCELLENCE IN JOURNALISM

Chicago Tribune



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ELECTION 2026
CPS BOARD

Rivals
fight to
stay on
ballot

School choice lobby
creating hurdles for
at least 14 candidates

By Kate Armanini
and Kate Perez
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Brenda Lee Anderson met and greeted every one of the 1,500 people who signed her petition to secure a spot on the ballot in November's school board election, the first in which Chicago voters will elect all 21 members.

In between teaching courses at Northwestern University, she recruited friends to help her canvass her Streeterville neighborhood. On one occasion, she even donned full academic regalia to put her credentials on display.

She was on "Cloud 10" when she submitted her signatures last month, she said, three times as many as required. Then she learned two people were formally contesting her nomination papers.

"This is why young people, why mothers, why all these people who have dreams and visions of running for public office, are pushed further from the idea," said Anderson, who is running in District 6A, which covers parts of the North Side.

Among the 51 people vying for a seat on the board, Anderson is one of 28 candidates facing objections to her candidacy.

Objections are filed when someone, typically connected to an opposing campaign, challenges the validity of a

See **BALLOT** on Page A4



A PLACE 'TO SEE
WHAT'S POSSIBLE'

Visitors from all over flock to Obama Presidential Center's opening day

By Darcel Rockett | CHICAGO TRIBUNE

The lines were many, the smiles countless and the pride priceless after setting foot on the Obama Presidential Center campus.

The word "magnificent" was uttered more than once.

Walkers and wheelchairs mingled with strollers and wagons where youths were carted around.

The feeling of community, brotherhood and sisterhood was evident as folks asked passersby to take their photos on opening day, which fell on Juneteenth, a federal holiday commemorating the emancipation of enslaved African Americans.

The Jackson Park museum opened to the public

Former President Barack Obama holds a baby as he and former first lady Michelle Obama greet community members in the Hope and Change lobby before they walk through the museum at the Obama Presidential Center on Friday.

EILEEN T. MESLAR/
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Friday, capping off more than a decade of anticipation and controversy, as the campus, which includes a forum building, parkland and a Chicago Public Library branch, reworked one of the city's most historic parks and a major thoroughfare.

Inside the presidential center, the Obamas greeted the first 100 visitors, according to a pool report.

Awed guests shook hands with former President Barack Obama and former first lady Michelle Obama against the backdrop of a colorful, 38-foot-tall painting depicting a map of Chicago stretching to the ceiling, inspired by Carl Sandburg's 1914

See **OBAMA** on Page A4

Mall's future
in limbo with
main building
set to close

By Brian J. Rogal
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

The main building at Chicago's Ford City Mall will shut down for good — by court order — at noon on Monday, ending a yearslong legal struggle between the city and the property's owner.

The vast indoor mall had a six-decade run as a top retail destination and gathering place for the Southwest Side's West Lawn community, but a growing number of empty stores and unsafe conditions led city officials to file a lawsuit and force its closure.

Most of the few stores that remained inside have already closed. Outdoor tenants in the property's North Mall and on



A shopper exits a JCPenney store with "store closing" signs at Ford City Mall in Chicago on Friday. JOHN J. KIM/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

other nearby lots, including Planet Fitness, IHOP and the AMC Ford City 14 movie theaters, were not targeted by the city and all remain open for business.

The future of the almost empty mall at 7601 S. Cicero Ave. remains in limbo. An industrial developer has proposed tearing it down and building several warehouses on the site. But North Mall store

owners worry demolition could disrupt their water supply, and neighborhood advocates want to preserve the land as a community hub, with housing, more outdoor retail and green space.

"I'm OK with the (indoor) mall going away. Things get torn down and rebuilt all the time,"

See **MALL** on Page A2

Israel, Hezbollah OK
halt to heavy fighting

By Erin Cunningham,
Jon Gambrell
and Aamer Madhani
ASSOCIATED PRESS

JERUSALEM — Israel and the Iranian-backed Hezbollah militant group agreed Friday to halt the heavy fighting in southern Lebanon that had threatened to unravel an interim agreement between the United States and Iran to end their war, officials said. Neither Israel nor Hezbollah immediately confirmed the truce.

It came after a heavy exchange of fire killed 47 people in Lebanon and four Israeli soldiers.

Hezbollah and Israel went to war shortly after the outbreak of

the wider conflict, with Hezbollah firing rockets and drones at civilian communities in northern Israel and Israel seizing large swaths of southern Lebanon.

The interim agreement to end the Iran war has already reopened the Strait of Hormuz, which Iran effectively closed, cutting the global economy off from significant supplies of oil and natural gas. The deal would also relaunch talks on Iran's nuclear program, the core issue over which Israel and the U.S. began the war on Feb. 28.

But the accord already faces threats, chiefly from Lebanon,

See **LEBANON** on Page A2

■ As Iranian media boast of the "magnificent defeat" of the U.S., Tehran is racing to sell oil under the interim peace agreement and trying to halt Israeli attacks in Lebanon. **Nation & World, Page B4**

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